## GLOSSARY

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|---|---|---|---|
| sage | - wise man | mused | - thought over |
| yore | - long ago | curious | - eager to learn more |
| pigtail | - a plaited lock of hair worn singly at the back | mystery | - puzzle |
| | | stout | - thick in structure |



**William Makepeace Thackeray** was one of the great novelists of the English Victorian Age. His 'Vanity Fair' is one of the finest and best-known novels in English literature. Thackeray wrote in a colorful, lively style, with a simple vocabulary and clearly- structured sentences. These qualities, combined with his honest view of life, give him an important place in the history of realistic literature.

### A. Answer the following.

1. What made the sage upset?
2. Why did the sage spin all day?
3. What solution did he arrive at for the mystery that he found?
4. Was he finally successful in changing his pigtail's position? Support your answer with a line from the poem.
5. Did something dreadful happen? How would you describe the events in the poem– comedy or tragedy?

### B. Read the poem lines and answer the questions given below.

1. But wondered much and sorrowed more
   Because it hung behind him.
   a) What was he wondering about?
   b) What does the word 'it' refer to here?

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2. And though his efforts never slack
   And though he twist, and twirl, and tack,
   Alas! Still faithful to his back
   The pigtail hangs behind him.
   a) Pick out the rhyming words from the above lines and give the rhyme scheme for the same.
   b) Did he quit his trying? How can you say?
3. 'He mused upon this curious case'
   What is the figure of speech used in this line?
4. **Irony** is a figure of speech in which words are used in such a way that their intended meaning is different from the actual meaning. It may also be a situation that ends up in quite a different way than what is generally anticipated. In simple words, it is a difference between appearance and reality.
   Can this poem be called an ironic poem? Justify your answer.



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